



Partly sunny 83/66 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 85/68 B20

Democracy Dies in Darkness

FRIDAY, AUGUST 8, 2025 • \$4

Israel poised to take over Gaza City

Security cabinet decision may preface a further escalation of the war

BY SHIRA RUBIN, GERRY SHIH AND LIOR SOROKA

TEL AVIV — Israel's security cabinet approved a plan for the Israel Defense Forces to take over Gaza City, opening the door to further escalation in the 22-month war in Gaza.

The decision was reached in the early hours of Friday after an hours-long security cabinet, according to the Associated Press. It also followed remarks by Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu on the previous day in which he said Israel intends to take military control of the entire Gaza Strip in an interview with Fox News.

The military's senior leadership, including chief of staff Eyal Zamir, had opposed conquering and reoccupying all of Gaza, according to two former Israeli officials and a person familiar with the prime minister's decisions. That person spoke on the condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to speak with the media.

Zamir and his commanders were expected to also lay out plans that include striking and besieging — but not entering — Gaza City, as well as the central area's refugee camps, to pressure Hamas.

SEE GAZA ON A12

Israeli media: News of starvation crisis begins to break through. **A11**

Watching from afar: Md. woman's family in Gaza goes hungry. **A13**



A view of the Port of Shanghai. While the United States has a temporary truce with China on tariffs, other levies took effect Thursday.

Plans to hold migrants at military bases take shape

BY MARIA SACCHETTI, DAN LAMOTHE, DAVID NAKAMURA AND DOUGLAS MACMILLAN

The Trump administration's plan to install large-scale detention facilities on U.S. military bases is taking shape, with Fort Bliss preparing to detain at least 1,000 undocumented immigrants starting this month on the Mexican border, U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement officials said Wednesday.

The sprawling Army post in El Paso is expected to hold 5,000 people in tentlike facilities at full capacity, which would turn it into

Administration wants to house people there ahead of deportations

the largest detention facility in the United States for civil detainees. ICE spokeswoman Emily Covington confirmed that authorities began holding migrants at Fort Bliss on Aug. 1.

Last month, Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth also approved the temporary use of Camp Atterbury in Indiana and Joint Base McGuire-Dix-Lakehurst in New

Jersey to house several thousand migrants before they are deported. Hegseth also green-lit a small expansion of detention beds at the Guantánamo Bay Naval Station in Cuba, the officials said, though the total number remains far lower than what President Donald Trump had planned for.

Taken together, the bases are at the core of the Trump administration's efforts to carry out rapid removals from the United States and a model for expanded Pentagon involvement in domestic deportation operations going forward. The plans would deepen Homeland Security's footprint in the northern U.S., where deten-

tion centers are in short supply and state laws limit cooperation with federal immigration enforcement.

"These facilities have been identified as strategic locations for detention, processing and removal operations by DHS," Andrew Whitaker, executive secretary for the Department of Homeland Security, said in a June 10 letter to defense officials requesting "immediate access" to the bases in Indiana, New Jersey and Guantánamo. He said the bases

SEE MIGRANTS ON A6

Alligator Alcatraz: Judge orders temporary halt to construction. **A8**

Tariffs force new era of trade

IMPORT TAX RATE AT HIGHEST SINCE 1933

Trump says his system 'is just in its infancy'

BY JACOB BOGAGE AND DAVID J. LYNCH

President Donald Trump celebrated the start of his long-awaited tariffs Thursday, declaring that money was "flowing into the USA at levels not thought even possible!" — though economists say the cost of the import taxes will probably get passed on to U.S. consumers and businesses.

Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick said the federal government could collect \$50 billion a month in tariff revenue, which Trump administration officials hope will be a boon to the United States' dismal financial health.

U.S. stocks finished mixed Thursday, as investors appeared unbothered by the new taxes. The Dow Jones Industrial Average and the S&P 500 posted minor losses, but the tech-heavy Nasdaq composite index showed gains after Trump announced he would exempt tech firms with plans to build domestically from massive new import duties on chips and semiconductors. Markets mostly rose in Asia and Europe on Thursday.

The larger economic picture

SEE TARIFFS ON A15

Negotiations: Boost in exports could stiffen China's resolve. **A14**

Tariffs' impact: Where things stand with trade partners. **A15**

Putin sees an edge in dealings on Ukraine

Russian leader faces few demands amid Trump's abrupt desire to meet

This article is by Robyn Dixon, Siobhán O'Grady, Catherine Belton, Francesca Ebel and Natalie Allison

President Donald Trump's abrupt shift from frustration with Russian President Vladimir Putin's intransigence to a potential one-on-one meeting soon — despite Putin's refusal to halt attacks on Ukraine or back away from Russia's core war aims — handed the Russian leader a diplomatic coup, which the Kremlin embraced Thursday.

After mixed signals in which the U.S. special envoy, Steve Witkoff, met with Putin for three hours Wednesday in Moscow and the White House then imposed stiff new tariffs on India, citing its support for Russia's war economy, Trump suddenly announced that he intended to meet with Putin "very soon" and that "there's a very good chance" of reaching an agreement on the conflict in Ukraine.

Putin on Thursday confirmed

SEE PUTIN ON A9



CRAIG HUDSON/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Phillip Todd, an aide to Sen. Rand Paul (R-Kentucky), participates in a prayer circle with friends in March 2024 to mark one year since he was randomly attacked in Northeast Washington.

A D.C. stabbing survivor rethinks criminal justice

Senate staffer turns to his faith as he weighs how to use his voice and what to say to the defendant

BY EMILY DAVIES

Bleeding from his brain and minutes from surgery that would determine whether he lived or died, Phillip Todd had a question.

He looked at his mother, sitting by his hospital bed.

Did anyone know the name of the attacker who had singled him out on a busy street in Northeast Washington?

She tapped her phone and searched, "H Street stabbing."

Todd, then 26 and an aide to Sen. Rand Paul (R-Kentucky), was picking up a burrito bowl on a March afternoon in 2023 when a stranger emerged from the shadows and stabbed him

four times for no sane reason. The attack came during an exceptionally violent period in the nation's capital, with the 2023 homicide toll reaching a 26-year high. Congressional Republicans, berating city officials as soft on crime, began threatening to end the District's ability to govern itself. They were joined by then-presidential candidate Donald Trump.

That day at MedStar Washington Hospital Center — before Todd's surgery and the start of his long physical and emotional recovery — his mom, Helen Todd, glanced up from her phone. She had found a news article identifying the

SEE STAFFER ON A20

In multiple states, GOP takes up White House push to redraw election maps

BY KADIA GOBA, NATALIE ALLISON AND HANNAH KNOWLES

Republicans are exploring ways to redraw congressional maps in their favor well beyond Texas as President Donald Trump pushes for aggressive changes, worrying some in the party who have little appetite for an escalating redistricting war with Democrats.

The White House has been driving the GOP redistricting effort, according to people familiar with the process, some of whom spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe private conversations. Republicans are discussing ways to create new red seats in Missouri, Indiana and Ohio ahead of next year's midterm elections and carve out as many as five in Florida, even as they face legal hurdles.

A White House spokesperson said staffers have not drawn any maps. John McLaughlin, one of Trump's pollsters, said the president doesn't want to risk facing Democratic-led investigations, as he previously did, if the party retakes control of Congress.

"After everything he's been through, I don't think he wants to leave anything to chance that would allow his opponents to do

what they did to him in the first term and in the subsequent years," McLaughlin said.

Some elected Republicans are skeptical of the push to redraw, concerned about Democratic retaliation in blue states and hesitant to shake up long-standing lines. In GOP-controlled Indiana — where Vice President JD Vance met Thursday with state leaders and discussed redistricting —

many Republican state lawmakers are unenthusiastic about the idea, according to a GOP legislator who, like others, spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe private deliberations.

"There's not much interest at this point," the legislator said,

SEE GOP ON A4

Texas: Will GOP succeed in efforts to expel Democrats who fled? **A4**

IN THE NEWS

New census President Donald Trump wants to conduct a survey that would not count people present in the country illegally. **A3**

Ultra-processed foods More than half of Americans' daily caloric intake, particularly among children, comes from the increasingly derided dietary choices, the CDC reported. **A2**

THE NATION

The FBI forced out at least three senior officials, including a former acting director. **A3**
As tastes change, the orange juice industry in Florida also faces agricultural challenges. **A7**

THE WORLD

Germany's trains no longer run on time, creating a national identity crisis. **A10**
A slain Palestinian activist involved with an Oscar-winning film was laid to rest. **A11**

THE ECONOMY

Smart glasses can be helpful, but a reporter who spent months testing them found that they can lead to awkward interactions. **A14**
Almost 2 million Americans are on unemployment, the highest number since November 2021. **A16**

STYLE

Lindsay Lohan is back in theaters after a decade. It's a testament to her resilience. **B1**

SPORTS

The Commanders open their preseason tonight at New England, and there are plenty of roster battles worth keeping an eye on. **B7**

THE REGION

Lanternflies are swarming in Virginia, threatening its \$8 billion wine industry. **B13**

WEEKEND

An abundance of fun — and funnel cakes — can be had at the region's county fairs, which run over the next several weeks.

BUSINESS NEWS.....	A14
COMICS.....	B4
OBITUARIES.....	B15
OPINION PAGES.....	A17
TELEVISION.....	B6
WORLD NEWS.....	A10

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54302

